If Dad Ever Needs to Apply

A worksheet for who would handle it, whom you'd call and what you'd ask.

If Dad ever applied for Medicaid, someone would fill in the forms, someone would know which drawer the statements are in, and someone would make the phone calls. In most families nobody has said out loud who that would be.

Fill this in with Dad, in pencil. Write names and preferences as they stand today, and where you don't know, write “don't know yet” and leave it.

The fourth box is for questions, not answers. When it would be time to apply is worked out with a professional who knows Dad's state.

Who would handle an application

The person Dad would want filling in the forms and answering questions about his records, and a second person in case the first can't. Write what Dad says. This records what he'd want; whether anything more is needed for that person to act for him is a question for an elder law attorney.

FOR EXAMPLE Dad says Carol, since she lives closest and already sits with him at tax time. Marcus second. Carol hasn't been asked yet.

Who knows where the records are

Who could put their hands on Dad's papers today, and who else he'd like to know where they're kept.

FOR EXAMPLE Only Dad so far. He's fine with Carol knowing about the gray file box in the hall closet. The online accounts he'd rather keep to himself for now.

Whom we'd call

The professionals your family would contact: your Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, whoever prepares Dad's taxes. A name and a number for each. Where there's no one yet, write “no one yet.”

FOR EXAMPLE Tax preparer: the office Dad has used for years; the card is in his desk. Elder law attorney: no one yet.

Our questions about when it would be time to apply

Write these as questions and leave the answers for your Medicaid planner. They might be about a change in Dad's care needs, his finances, planning that is still under way, or a move to a facility.

FOR EXAMPLE If Dad ever moved somewhere with more help, is that when we'd call, or sooner? Who works that out with us?

What we haven't settled

Anything above that Dad wants to think about, or that two of you see differently. Write both views and leave it.

FOR EXAMPLE Dad would rather not choose between Carol and Marcus yet. Come back to it over the holidays.

Who filled this in, the date, and when we'll look at it again

What this shows you

Three things: who Dad would want handling the paperwork, whom your family would call, and the questions you'd bring. The page stops there. It isn't the file of records, it doesn't say whether or when anyone should apply, and nothing on it adds up to a score or a level. Rules vary by state, so the timing questions go to your Medicaid planner. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've written down who would handle the paperwork for Dad, whom you'd call and what you'd ask. The planning interview picks up from there: it asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

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